a place of unparalleled glory destroyed in successive assaults by foreign invaders. He felt that a 'national regeneration' was necessary. He also contended that the national regeneration of this 'Hindu nation' (the 'motherland' for which the 'Hindu people' shed their blood)[13] could only come about through the revival of its Hinduness. Golwalkar rejected the concept of what he called 'territorial nationalism', the modern variant of nationalism which identified a state with its territory and bestowed equal rights of citizenship on all those who lived within it. That, to him, made no sense: a territory was not a nation, a people constituted a nation. Who were this people? In the Indian case, Hindus.[14] Golwalkar and the RSS became passionate advocates of 'cultural nationalism'.[15] This, of course, is directly opposed to the civic nationalism enshrined in the Constitution of India.

India's independence from colonial rule in 1947, Golwalkar argued, did not constitute real freedom because the new leaders held on to the 'perverted concept of nationalism' that located all who lived on India's territory as equal constituents of the nation. 'The concept of territorial nationalism,' he wrote, 'has verily emasculated our nation and what more can we expect of a body deprived of its vital energy? …[and] so it is that we see today the germs of corruption, disintegration and dissipation eating into the vitals of our nation for having given up the natural living nationalism in the pursuit of an unnatural, unscientific and lifeless hybrid concept of territorial nationalism.'[16]

Golwalkar's *Bunch Of Thoughts* argues that territorial nationalism is a barbarism, since a nation is 'not a mere bundle of political and economic rights' but an embodiment of national culture—in India, 'ancient and sublime' Hinduism. In his tract, Golwalkar sneers at democracy—which he sees as alien to Hindu culture. He also writes approvingly of the Laws of Manu as the work of a 'great soul'; he talks of the high regard in which *Manu Smriti* is held around the world by referring to a statue in the Philippines bearing the inscription: 'The first, the greatest and wisest lawgiver of mankind'. (That Manu's legal prescription is condemned by many for its elitism and casteism, its gender prejudice, its implicitly authoritarian ethos and its disparagement of the lower castes never crosses Golwalkar's mind.) But in all fairness, Golwalkar was only